

Hopeless Romantic

A Collection Of Poems

Kiminou Knox

Copyright © 2025 All rights reserved.

Dedication

*For those who have loved and died internally from it but to always understand that there is always hope in **love***

“The emotion that can break your heart is sometimes the very one that heals it.”

— Nicholas Sparks

“What is to give light must endure burning.”

— Viktor E. Frankl

*“Hope deferred makes the heart sick,
but a longing fulfilled is a tree of life.”*

— Proverbs 13:12

Table of Contents

★ Act I – The Offering

Come Heal Here-Love Is a Soft Place to Fall-Why Won't You Love Me-So God... There's This Girl-I Don't Need Much (Just You)- Do You Believe in Soulmates?- Let Me Love You in Peace

◆ Act II – The Cracks

How Did We Get Here- Say It Back- Maybe I'm Just Imagining It-Talking to Your Silence-One-Sided Prayers- Delivered Again- You Didn't Have to Pretend-If I Disappear, Will You Notice?

❖ Act III – The Spiral

I Swear You Felt It Too-This Song Sounds Like Us-I Dreamed You Said It-Still, Sometimes-53 Days-Even If You Don't Want Me I'll Wait-The Almost That Killed Me

✝ Act IV – The Break

FUCK YOU BITCH- You Played Me-Time I'll Never Get Back -You Wasn't Even My Baddest Bitch-Could've Done Better -I Should've Let You Drown-You Made Me Soft Just to Break Me I Don't Write About You No More-Was I Ever Enough?

✝ Act V – The Release

I Can Love Us Both-Hopeless Romantic-I Don't Need You to Choose Me- Stay As Long As You Need-I Was There When You Fell Apart-This Isn't Your Fault-Loving You Isn't a Mistake- I'd Still Pick You- My Hopeless Romantic Homegirl- If You Called, I'd Still Answer- You Looked Back Once-One Day We'll Laugh About This

Introduction

*I wasn't supposed to still feel it.
Not this long after. Not this deep.
But here I am still saving a seat for someone who left without saying goodbye.*

*This isn't a poetry book. Not really.
It's a memory spiral. A fever dream.
A collection of every time I should've let go but didn't.
Of every "wyd?" I answered when I knew better.
Every ghost. Every maybe. Every goddamn almost.*

*I didn't write these poems in order. I didn't live them that way either.
Some days I was healed.
Other days I still flinched at their name.
Sometimes I wanted to pray for them.
Sometimes I wanted to scream into their voicemail.
I did both.*

*You ever reread your own messages and feel like a stranger?
Yeah. That.*

*This is about the love that never fully landed.
The kind that lingers in your throat,
makes you feel stupid for being soft,
but even worse for pretending you're not.*

*These poems are for the nights you lied and said you were fine.
The mornings you made excuses for why they disappeared.
For the phone that lights up and doesn't say their name.
And for the times it does and ruins your whole week.*

*It's all in here.
The devotion. The delusion. The death of hope.
The way you keep setting the table for someone who never shows up.*

*This is what it looks like when you love out loud and it echoes.
This is what happens when your heart doesn't get the memo.
This is what "moving on" really means when your soul's still checking the door.*

*You're not crazy.
You're not too much.
You're just a hopeless romantic in a world that keeps pretending it doesn't care.*

*So here.
Take what breaks you.
Keep what heals you.
Leave what hurts too bad to hold. I'll still be here.
Writing about the silence like it ever loved me back.*

—Kiminou

